

HOMEWORK 7

Due date: Next Monday. Exercises: 1, 8, 9, 12, pages 105-107
 Exercises: 1, 3, page 111
 Exercises: 1, 3, 4, 6, 7, 8, pages 115-116.

You can do Problems 1, 2 and 3 using what you learned from last week.

Problem 1. Given two matrices $A, B \in \text{Mat}_{m \times n}(F)$. Show that $\text{rank}(A+B) \leq \text{rank}(A) + \text{rank}(B)$.

Hint: Translate this problem to a problem on linear maps. You might find the following fact useful: Given two linear maps $T, S : V \rightarrow W$, then $\ker(T) \cap \ker(S) \subset \ker(T+S)$ (check this).

Problem 2. Given two matrices $A, B \in \text{Mat}_{n \times n}(F)$. If $AB = 0$, show that $\text{rank}(A) + \text{rank}(B) \leq n$.

This follows from Sylvester's rank inequality (Problem 3, HW6). But it is a good exercise to prove this directly (without going through the whole proof of Sylvester, because this problem is much easier.) Hint: Think about what can you say about $\text{Im}(T_B)$ and $\text{Ker}(T_A)$. (As usual: T_A denotes the linear map $F^n \rightarrow F^n$ given by $T_A(X) = AX$. Here elements in F^n are viewed as column vectors.)

Problem 3. Let F be a fixed field and n be a positive integer. Denote by $I \in \text{Mat}_{n \times n}(F)$ the identity $n \times n$ matrix. Given $A, B \in \text{Mat}_{n \times n}(F)$.

(1) Show that

$$\text{rank}(A - ABA) = \text{rank}(A) + \text{rank}(I - BA) - n.$$

(2) Show that

$$\text{rank}(I - AB) = \text{rank}(I - BA).$$

Hint: The equation $A - ABA = A(I - BA) = (I - AB)A$ might be useful.

Problem 4. Denote $\alpha = \sqrt[3]{2}$. Consider $F = \{a + b\alpha + c\alpha^2 \mid a, b, c \in \mathbb{Q}\}$. We know that F is a field and it is also a vector space over $\mathbb{Q}$ of dimension 3 from previous HW. We view it as a $\mathbb{Q}$ -vector space.

- (1) Given $x = a + b\alpha + c\alpha^2 \in F$ and the linear map $T_x : F \rightarrow F$ given by $T_x(y) = xy$. It is not hard to see T_x is well-defined and $\mathbb{Q}$ -linear. Here "well-defined" means $T_x(y) \in F$ for $y \in F$. Suppose that $x \neq 0$. Show that T_x is injective and conclude that there exists a $y \in F$ such that $xy = 1$.
- (2) Fix an ordered basis $\mathcal{B}$ of F (as a $\mathbb{Q}$ vector space) and compute the matrix $[T_x]_{\mathcal{B}}$ of T_x with respect to the basis you chose.
- (3) Show that $[T_x]_{\mathcal{B}}$ is invertible (this is similar to part (4) of a problem)
- (4) Do a higher dimensional analogue of this. For example, given a matrix $A \in \text{Mat}_{2 \times 2}(F)$, and consider the linear map $T_A : F^2 \rightarrow F^2$. View F^2 as a $\mathbb{Q}$ -vector space and choose a basis $\mathcal{B}'$ of F^2 over $\mathbb{Q}$. Then compute $[T_A]_{\mathcal{B}'}$ explicitly in terms of entries of A . Show that if A is invertible as an element of $\text{Mat}_{2 \times 2}(F)$ then $[T_A]_{\mathcal{B}}$ is invertible as an element of $\text{Mat}_{6 \times 6}(\mathbb{Q})$.

Exercise 16 page 107 gives a "coordinate free" definition of trace of a square matrix. Please keep in mind this assertion. In Chapter 5, we will see a "coordinate free" definition of determinant. You can find a proof in this [link](#) of Ex 16, page 107. But the proof given there uses heavy computations. In the following problem, we will have a more conceptual proof. Basically, we do Exercise 17, page 107 first and we show Ex 17 implies Ex 16 easily.

Problem 5. Let F be a field and let $V = \text{Mat}_{n \times n}(F)$, which is an F -vector space of dimension n^2 . We consider the trace map $\text{Tr} : V \rightarrow F$. Let W be the subspace of V which is spanned by the matrices of the form $AB - BA$ for $A, B \in V$. Then we know that $W \subset \ker(\text{Tr})$. This space W is exactly the one in Ex 17, page 107.

- (1) Show that $\text{Tr} : V \rightarrow F$ is surjective and conclude that $\dim \ker(\text{Tr}) = n^2 - 1$.
- (2) Show that $\dim W = n^2 - 1$ by explicitly constructing enough linearly independent elements in W . (See the solution of Ex 17, page 107 given in the above link). Conclude that $W = \ker(\text{Tr})$.
- (3) Show that a linear functional $f : V \rightarrow F$ such that $f(AB) = f(BA)$ for all $A, B \in F$ is exactly an element in $\text{Hom}_F(V/W, F)$. Conclude that such an f must be of the form $c\text{Tr}$ for some $c \in F$.

Hint for part (2) if you don't check the solution given online. We expect that $W = \text{Ker}(\text{tr})$. Try to find a natural basis of $\ker(\text{tr})$ (if you still have no idea, try to think about the 2×2 matrices and then 3×3 matrices), and then try to show that they are indeed in W .

Problem 6. Given $V, W \in \text{Vect}_F$ such that $\dim V, \dim W$ are finite. Let $T : W \rightarrow V$ be a linear operator.

- (1) Given a linear functional $f \in W^*$ such that $f|_{\ker(T)} = 0$, show that there exists a linear functional $g \in V^*$ such that $g(T(\alpha)) = f(\alpha)$ for any $\alpha \in W$.
- (2) If T is injective, conclude that T^t is surjective.

Part (1) is a variant/generalization of Ex 12, page 106.

Problem 7. Let V, W be two finite dimensional vector spaces over F . Suppose $\dim_F V = n, \dim_F W = m$.

- (1) Show that the map $\theta : \text{Hom}_F(V, W) \rightarrow \text{Hom}_F(W^*, V^*)$ defined by $\theta(T) = T^t$ is an isomorphism.
- (2) Conclude that there is an isomorphism $\text{Hom}(V, W) \rightarrow (V^*)^m$. Construct this isomorphism explicitly using Problem 1, HW6.

(Comment: Part (1) is a generalization of Ex. 7, page 116.)

We can prove the assertion in part (2) of Problem 3 even we drop the condition that $\dim V$ is finite.